COVER STORY

# CELLTICK

## ENABLING OPERATORS, OEMS AND APP DEVELOPERS TO ENHANCE USER ENGAGEMENT

**By Shaheen Saikia**

Each of us, at some point in time, has been stuck at one of those endless traffic jams that are ridden by absolute monotony. Stuck in one of such traffic jams, along with many others, was an engineer staring at his mobile phone that was lying there idle while he waited for the vehicles ahead of him to slog along. The mobile phone, one of the most marveled at and yet a cursed piece of technological innovation which is often cited for its ability to engross users, failed to do anything for this engineer who saw nothing but the operator's name, signal strength and battery meter on the screen. And so he thought to himself, "What a shame!

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Ronen Daniel,
CEO

There is nothing on the screen which I can play with." Eventually, the traffic did move on however the engineer still pondered upon this thought he had while in the jam. Later he got together with few of his friends and they actually found a way to place content on the screen while the mobile device was in idle mode. The basic idea was to play with a technology similar to that of screen savers but with the right content to engage the users.

All of this happened in the early phase of the second millennium in the country of Israel. And the engineer in context is Ronen Daniel who heads Celltick Technologies as the CEO with the mantra- 'Discovery and Engagement'.

## New Age Marketing

Marketing Technology has undergone drastic changes. Consumers behavior, now exposed to a wide range of channels to arrive at the same destination, have become unpredictable and indifferent. Hence, market leaders are left with no choice but to invest in newer platforms and tools to support customer interactions at every point of the buyer journey. Today the most popular communication medium to reach out to the consumers is undoubtedly the mobile devices. However, this medium, like many others, isn't free from loopholes and challenges. Ronen Daniel, providing an insight in this area opines, "If you take Android, one of the common platforms today in the globe, you'll see that in Google Play alone there are over two million apps. The problem here is that nearly sixty percent of all of these apps are launched not more than ten times. Hence, it can be concluded that organizations are investing a lot, both in terms of effort and resources at developing apps. However, at the end of the day, you realize that nobody uses them. When an app wants to engage with you then it'll probably send you a notification. This is how it reminds you that it exists."

## From an Idea to Solutions that Drive Revenues

Celltick Technologies, a provider of solutions in the mobile marketing domain, has rolled out a number of innovative platforms and apps each of which ensures high visibility and exhibits great engagement capabilities. These solutions can be leveraged by mobile operators, OEMs-ODMs and app developers distributed all over the world to enhance discovery and engagement of their content and services while in the process monetize on the medium. Celltick's patented product, Livescreen, was born out of the same concept of engaging the user with screen saver content on the screen while the mobile device was in idle mode. Again, for Android users, mobile operators,



Ronen Daniel, CEO

## GIVING BACK TO THE WORLD

*Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) forms an important part of the activities at Celltick. Hence, one is likely to see Celltick in the forefront, in many parts of the world, including India, contributing to the society. The firm together with its partner operators collaborated with the Ministry of Women and Children Development- India, to spread awareness about BetiBachao BetiPadhao to over 100 million mobile users. Celltick also partnered with Sri Lanka's Ministry of Health to spread awareness to over five million mobile users against Dengue in the state. The firm also campaigned for AIDS and Breast Cancer in Africa and other parts of the world. Ronen Daniel says that the firm acknowledges its responsibility towards the society and hence reaches out to people in rural areas and people in need from time to time to deliver life-saving messages, both as a part of Government initiatives as well as the firm's initiatives.*



OEMs-ODMs, and app developers can leverage Celltick's product Start. Driven by business intelligence and analytics Start offers users a completely personalized start screen experience. With the scope for endless customizations, users get a single-swipe access to their most favorite apps, contacts, social feeds, music, videos content and anything that matters to them the most. "What we are doing here is a blend of what matters to the users and what matters to the brands. And we have mastered this art of blending with an experience gained over two decades. All our products are able to engage the end users the minute they wake up their phones. Turn on your device and there is a whole world that is waiting for you", reiterates the CEO.

Celltick started off with LiveScreen in late 2002, at a time when apps still had to catch up in trend. The platform comes integrated with the SIM cards of various network operators. The highly interactive solution enables banking institutions, insurance bodies, e-commerce centers and other service providers who are regularly required to update customers with various notifications, to send added messages about new offers or loans that may interest the end customer. Following the unprecedented success of the product in driving revenues for Celltick's partners, it has found widespread acceptance from most leading SIM providers. The product also aids in homeland security due to its widespread penetration and ability to send messages in real time within seconds to millions of users in different locations. Ronen Daniel citing an example says, "Due to LiveScreen's reach in Sri Lanka and India, we were actually able to save lives here during the tsunami. We switched immediately from commercial broadcasts to preventive/emergency broadcasts. After the tsunami, we directed users to the locations where they could find food, water and medicine. After the event, we saw the power in the system and directed our efforts to enhance it and built it into a mission critical system." While Celltick also offers Mass Alert that works in collaboration with government bodies and operators around the world to ensure public safety during natural calamities such as the aforementioned, LiveScreen differentiates itself from Mass Alert as a commercial entity.

Keeping in view the challenges that many mobile operators, device manufacturers, and app developers face to engage users, Celltick has recently put forth Start Magazine, a CaaS (Content-as-a-Service) solution. The solution provides a wide array of contents to over 200 countries with different languages, lifestyles, and tastes. It can be leveraged by clients in the form of Content-as-a-Service whereby they are free to pick any content from any category within a few clicks. The content can also be integrated with appropriate ads, depending on the geography and language. Talking about a leading provider in the mobile devices segment, Xiaomi, who in its attempts to penetrate the Indian market, faced fierce competition from the existing mobile device providers. They sought for a way to localize their devices to the India market so that they are able to create a distinction in the market. Celltick enabled them with rich Indian content through Start Magazine, thus establishing Xiaomi into one of the most sought after mobile brands in India.

## Continuous Efforts towards Innovation

Celltick Technologies is an established name that has been driving the mobile marketing domain with revolutionary solutions. The firm boasts of 250 million LiveScreen users and sixty million installs of Start. And the figure continues to grow. Since its penetration in the Indian markets in 2002, Celltick has partnered with all the major mobile network operators Vodafone, Reliance, Airtel, Idea, BSNL, Aircel and more in the region of Sri-Lanka and Bangladesh with around a billion mobile users in India alone. The CEO reveals that 9 out of every 10 SIM cards today in India are preloaded with the LiveScreen app. He further adds, "Rich penetration such as these motivates us to continue innovating and at the same time enables us to take our products to new horizons". Ronen Daniel also divulges that the firm has been witnessing a growing demand for Mass Alert from a number of countries including Indonesia, Singapore, Philippines, Taiwan, Latin America, Canada, USA and more. It has been responses such as these keep the team of Celltick driven to deliver to the goal. However, the CEO who envisages taking over the Indian markets completely believes there is still a lot of work to be done. CR